From “Nobody Is Helping” to What Actually Happened

A care concerns worksheet: each concern about your father's care, beside an example of what happened.

“Nobody is helping” is how it feels, and said out loud on a family call it starts an argument. “He missed his Tuesday appointment and no one knew until Thursday” is something that happened, and a family can talk about that.

Take one concern at a time and use a fresh copy of this page for each. Write what happened, with the day. Where you don't have an example, write “no example yet” and move on.

The concern, in the words it was said

Write it the way you heard it, or the way you'd say it yourself, even if it sounds unfair. Note who said it and when.

FOR EXAMPLE “Nobody is looking after him properly.” My brother, on Sunday's call.

What actually happened

One example: what happened or didn't happen, and on which day. Leave out who should have done it.

FOR EXAMPLE He missed his Tuesday appointment. No one knew until Thursday.

What was seen, and what you think it means

Two separate lines. The first is what someone saw or heard. The second is what you made of it. Keep both, and keep them apart.

FOR EXAMPLE Seen: his prescription was still waiting at the pharmacy on Friday. What I think: nobody is keeping track of refills. I haven't asked anyone yet.

How it touches his day

What was different for your father because of it, as far as anyone has seen. Ask him. If nobody knows, write that.

FOR EXAMPLE He told me he was dressed and waiting by the window at nine. As far as I know, the appointment hasn't been rescheduled.

What you'd need to find out

The parts of this concern nobody has checked, and who would know. Don't guess.

FOR EXAMPLE I don't know who had the appointment written down, or whether anyone was asked to drive him. My sister would know.

Who wrote this page, and the date

What this shows you

For each concern, three things: whether you have an example, whether what was seen and what you made of it are the same, and what you still don't know. It doesn't show whose fault anything is or what your father needs. Nothing here adds up to a score or a level, and questions about his health or his medications go to the people who look after them.

Ready for the next step?

You've put an example beside each concern, in place of an accusation. The care interview picks up from there: it goes through your father's situation area by area, including the parts no one has complained about yet, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›